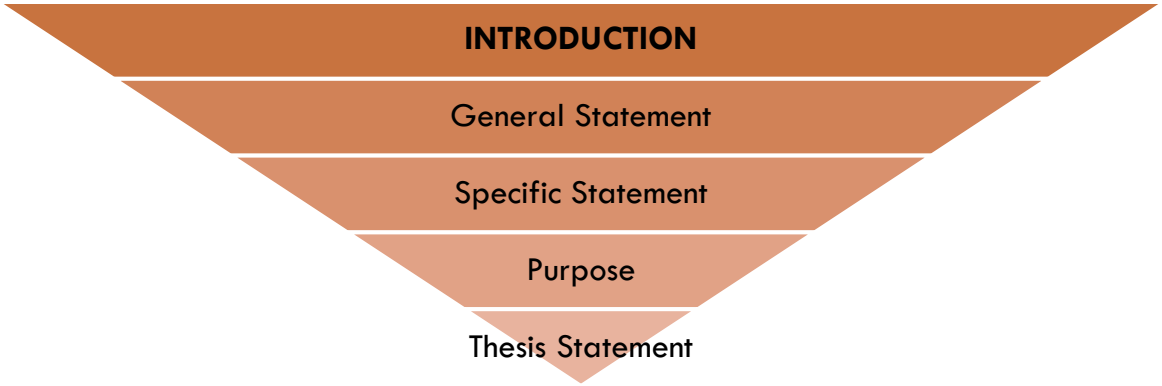
STRUCTURE OF AN ESSAY

What is an Essay

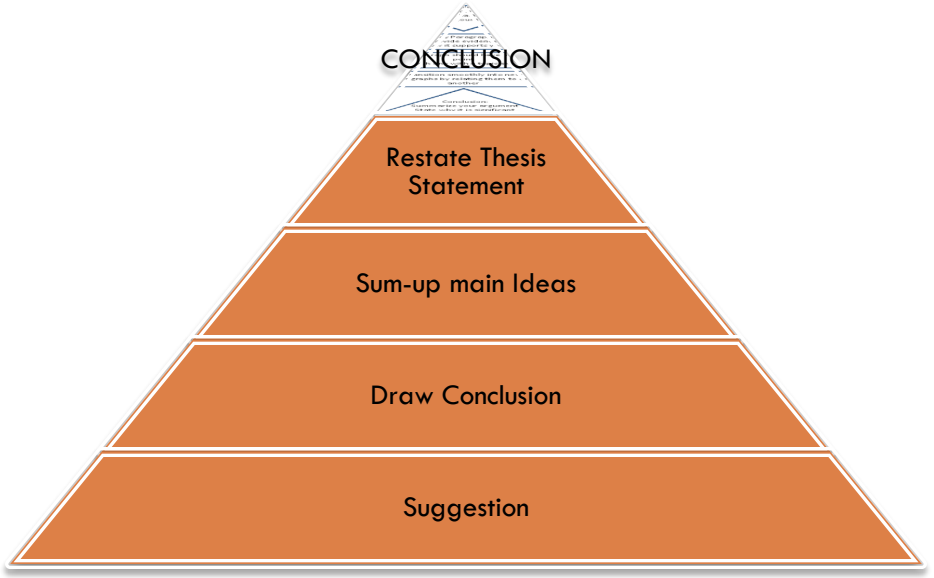
- An essay is a concise piece of nonfiction writing that aims to either inform the reader about a topic or argue a particular perspective.
- Most academic essays are highly formal, whereas informal essays are commonly found in journal entries, social media, or even blog posts.

How long is an essay?

- The length of an essay can vary from a few hundred to several thousand words but typically falls between 500–5,000 words.
- Typically, an essay has five paragraphs:
- 1. an introduction
- 2. a conclusion, and
- 3. three body paragraphs.
- However, there is no set rule about the number of paragraphs in an essay.
- The number of paragraphs can vary depending on the type and scope of your essay. An expository or argumentative essay may require more body paragraphs to include all the necessary information, whereas a narrative essay may need fewer.



1. • Body para 1
2. • Body Para 2
3. • Body Para 3



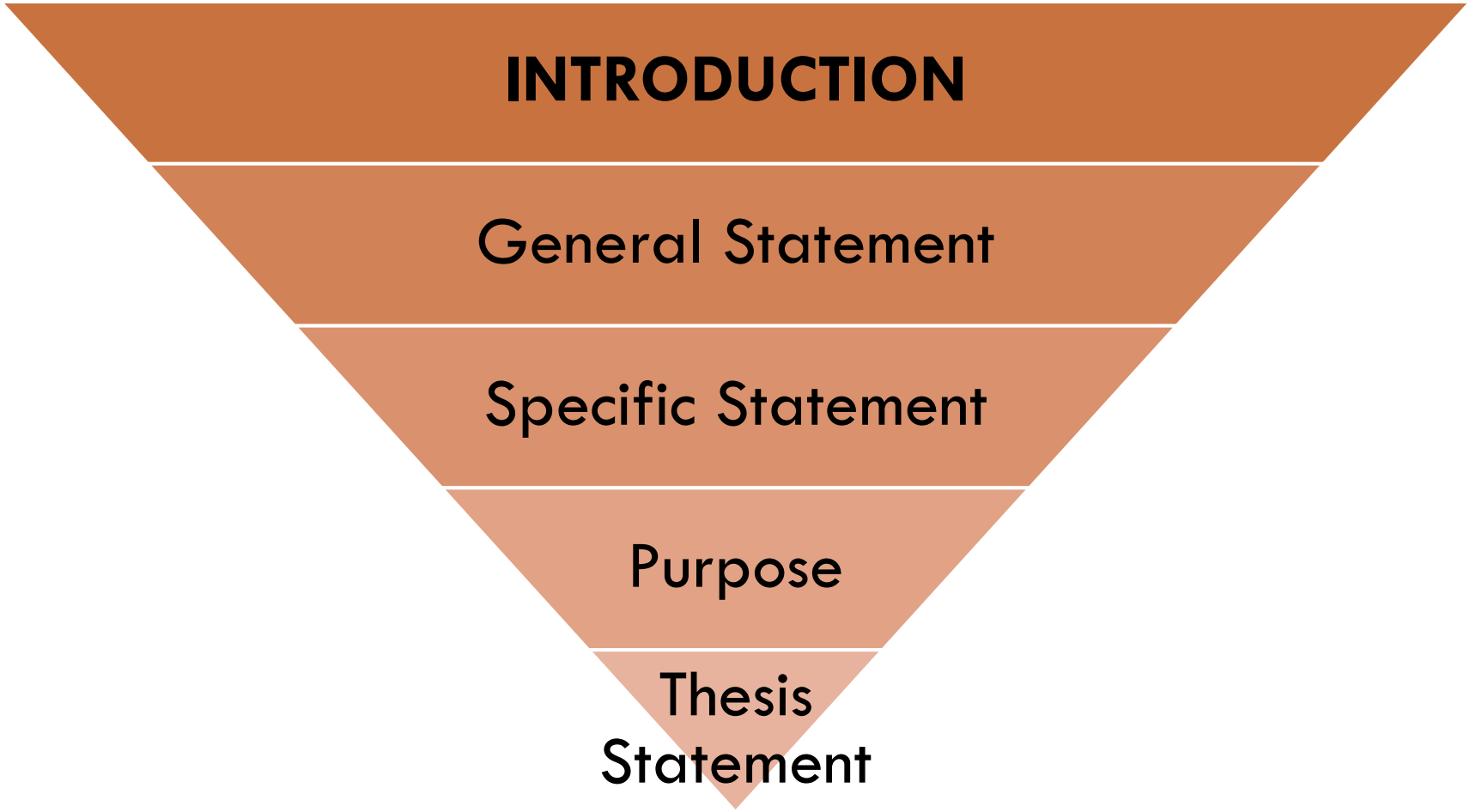
Introduction

- **The introduction** sets the stage for your essay and is typically a paragraph long. It should grab the reader's attention and give them a clear idea of what your essay will be about.
- Start with a general statement
- Write a bit of specific information
- State the purpose of the essay
- Write the thesis statement

Thesis Statement

- A thesis statement is one complete sentence that expresses your position.
- Narrows the topic down to a specific focus of an investigation.
- Establishes a direction for the entire paper.
- Points forward to the conclusion.
- Always stated in your introduction. (Usually at the end of the first paragraph).
- Always take a stand and justify further discussion.

Introduction



The Body Paragraphs

- **The body** is where you dive deeper into your topic and present your arguments and evidence. It usually consists of three paragraphs, but this can vary depending on the type of essay you're writing.
- Para 1. Write the main idea/topic sentence then explain
- Para 2. Write the main idea/topic sentence then explain
- Para3. Write the main idea/topic sentence then explain

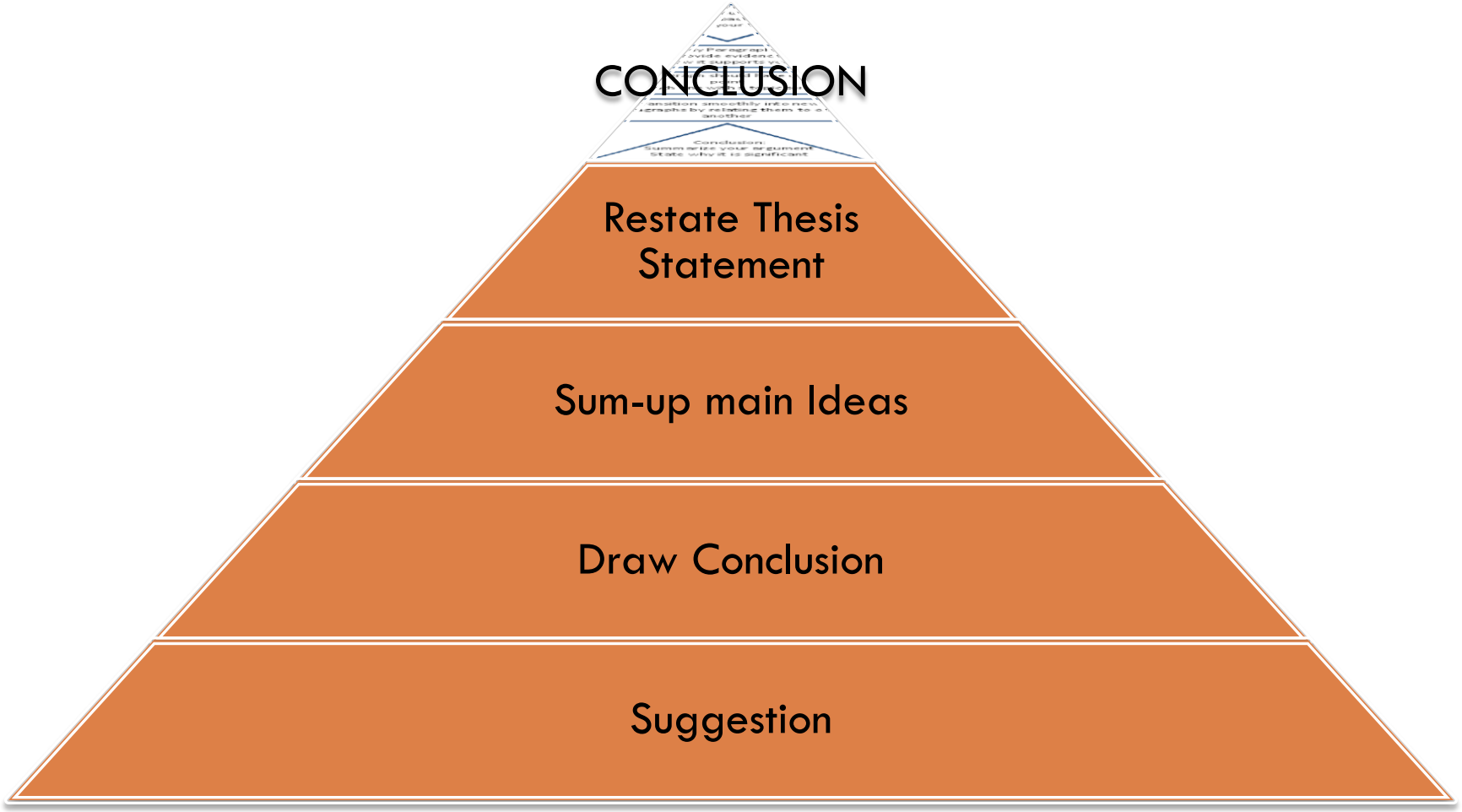
Body Paragraphs

1. • Body para 1
2. • Body Para 2
3. • Body Para 3

The Conclusion

- **The conclusion** brings your essay to a close and is typically one paragraph long. It should summarize the main points of the essay and leave the reader with something to think about
- Restate the title
- Then restate the thesis statement
- Sum-up the main ideas
- Give suggestions

Conclusion


CONCLUSION
Restate Thesis Statement
Sum-up main Ideas
Draw Conclusion
Suggestion